

LISTENING

#19

1 – Listen to a conversation between a customer and a server.
Answer the questions to find out what the customer orders, the menu details, and the total cost

Hamburger Restaurant

1 - Where does the customer decide to eat, here or to go?

2 - Why does the customer refuse the one-pound super hot and spicy cheeseburger?

3 - Name some of the ingredients in the “Everything-but-the-kitchen-sink” drink.

4 - How does the customer describe the drink when the server explains it?

5 - What does the customer finally order?

6 - What side does the server suggest?

7 - How much is the total for the customer’s order initially?

8 - What menu option does the server suggest for a smaller burger?

9 - What does the customer decide to order at the end?

health guidelines recommend, making them a significant factor in the global rise in obesity.

Researchers measured the weight and energy content of 223 popular main dishes purchased from 111 restaurants in Brazil, China, Finland, Ghana and India, and compared them with earlier U.S. data. What they discovered was striking: 94% of the sit-down restaurant meals studied contained more than 600 kilocalories (kcal), the benchmark recently suggested by the UK's National Health Service for a main meal. Meals from fast-food outlets were somewhat smaller on average, but still very high—72% of those in this sample exceeded the 600 kcal threshold.

Some specific examples stand out: in Brazil a typical dish (rice, beans, chicken, cassava and salad with a bread roll) weighed 841 g and contained 1,656 kcal; in India a popular mutton biryani dish weighed 1,012 g and contained 1,463 kcal; and in Ghana a classic fufu, goat and soup meal weighed 1,105 g and had 1,151 kcal. The researchers found a strong correlation between dish weight and calorie content, concluding that people are often eating more simply because portions are larger, not just because food is unhealthy. The study suggests that the problem is not only the nutritional quality of food (though that matters), but also the sheer amount of food served.

One of the co-authors pointed out that while health campaigns often focus on “bad” food or “junk” food, they should also pay attention to portion size. According to the World Health Organization (WHO), obesity is already a global epidemic and a major risk factor for diseases like heart disease, stroke and diabetes. In short, large portions served by restaurants around the world may be a hidden but powerful driver of excess calorie intake and the growing worldwide problem of obesity.

Retrieved from: <https://www.business-standard.com/article/news-ani/oversized-meals-a-factor-in-obesity-study>

Comprehension Questions

1. According to the study, what percentage of restaurant meals contained more than 600 calories?

2. What relationship did researchers find between portion size and calorie content?

3. Why do the authors suggest focusing on portion size, not just on the type of food eaten?

4. Do you think restaurants should offer smaller portions as a way to promote healthier eating? Why or why not?

5. When you eat out, do you usually finish large portions or save part of the meal for later?